

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

Simply Alia

Favourite food
Poha and French fries

Favourite leisure activity
Sleeping

Fitness mantra
Work out a LOT

Funniest day in life
Every time I watch US sitcom FRIENDS

Worst nightmare
Being in a tsunami

Current favourite reads
Will by Will Smith, *Greenlights* by Matthew McConaughey

Her pet
Edward, my five-year-old Persian cat

Favourite colour
White

Inner circle
All my school friends from Jamnabai Narsee–Meghna, Akanksha, Kripa, Devika, Rhea, Disha and Tanya

Favourite actors
Ranbir Kapoor, Ranveer Singh, Allu Arjun

Investments:
Phool, a start-up that converts floral waste into incense products; Nykaa; started children's sustainable clothing line Ed-a-mamma

"I know what it takes to be an actor and I didn't have it easy," says Razdan, Alia's mum and Bhatt's second wife. "Who is to know what she'd have?" Alia, who along with Shaheen, moved out of her family home around 2016, does not share her approach with either parent. Razdan would discover that her daughter watched *Mandi*, Shyam Benegal's acclaimed drama in which she played a sex worker, as prep for *Gangubai*... only during our conversation for this piece.

HOME AND HEART

"Restless" is how Alia describes herself. I need to be doing something constantly," she says. "And I can't do the same thing again and again. I find it boring." A foodie, it's a running joke among her friends on how frequently she

ON SISTER SHAHEEN

"There is not an uncomfortable bone between us. We don't take each other for granted and are mindful of each other's spaces and capacity. We have similar sensibilities. She's a writer herself. I want her to bring stories and put together stuff for Eternal Sunshine"



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